

setting. And he had no regrets. A few days after joining, Aakash had even convinced the management to start an office productivity project centred around FOSS, under his leadership.

Problems as opportunities

Platitudes apart, that is exactly how it happened. Clients were expected the following week for an 'ideation' session. It was to be a freewheeling meeting with white boards and flip charts instead of prepared OHP slides. The minutes of the meeting had to be as accurate as possible and available almost immediately after the meeting, so that they could be agreed upon and signed off. A lot depended on the professional conduct of the meeting to make a favourable impression on the clients.

A solution of sorts did exist. It was the electronic white board, which had two writing surfaces and could copy the contents of the board on to special paper. The results were far from satisfactory and the copies were always in black and white. Distributing the minutes was a chore. But even that facility went out of order with no spares available. Piyush, the head of marketing, was convinced that the only way to make accurate minutes was to take pictures of the white board and flip charts with his digital camera, and attach them to his minutes. "Not a very elegant approach; but it would have to do," thought Piyush. He did mention his problem to Aakash as the two met briefly before Piyush drove home.

Aakash had almost reversed out of the parking lot when it struck him that there was a way out. He re-parked his car and ran back to his cubicle collecting the keys to the conference room from the reception. There was work to be done...

The goal-driven use case here was straight forward. The company needed a 'cost-effective', 'elegant', and 'reliable' means to capture meeting minutes with a minimal turnaround time.

The Saturday movie and after

It was a relatively lazy Saturday after a long time. Piyush and Aakash planned to grab a quick brunch before retiring to the noon show of 2012 and calling it a day. At least that was the plan. Things did go as planned but Piyush seemed preoccupied throughout. After the movie, instead of driving homeward, Aakash steered his car towards the office. "Where are we going?" asked Piyush. "Wait till I show you something," said Aakash.

Once at the office, they quickly went into the conference room. Waiting there was a laptop with a digital projector and digital tablet connected to it. "Is this some kind of a joke?" thought Piyush, not quite appreciating the set-up, yet he decided to stay quiet and let Aakash speak first.

What we are about to see is one realisation of this use case. There might be others. We deliberately chose a goal-driven use case over one that's 'system interaction' driven to broaden the solution space.

The realisation

The 4 p.m. sun was lighting up the glass panes towards the west. "Lower the blinds, will you?" Aakash requested Piyush. This was getting a little too melodramatic for Piyush's taste. Aakash had already booted into the GNOME desktop and was scrolling down items in the 'Office' menu. The next moment, an application screen filled the far wall of the conference room as the digital projector warmed up. It was a giant notepaper with a couple of tool bars on top. Piyush wished this thing would end or that Aakash would say something. Instead, Aakash picked up the stylus of the digital tablet and wrote 'Get it?'. A huge version of these words appeared scrawled on the far wall.

Suddenly, Piyush straightened up in his chair. This looked useful.

"This is Xournal," said Aakash. "It is a pen-based note journal that can also be used to take notes. Let me


redhat®
TRAINING PARTNER
RHCE / RHCSS Exam Centre
 Hundreds of hardcore
 Industry Professionals
 Vouch for it.



- Pioneer in LINUX training since 1999.
- Chennai's #1 RHCE training Centre
- 100% results every month.
- Many centum students.
- Also get trained on My SQL - CMDBA, CMDEV, PHP, Perl, Ruby, Python, Ajax...

Next RHCE/RHCSS Exam
7th & 21st December '09

Don't wait.
Register Now.
 Let the success vouch for you!

ADVANTAGE PRO
 IT TRAINING DIVISION OF
 Vectra Technosoft Pvt. Ltd.
 Open Source Academy

Regd. Off: Wing 1 & 2, IV Floor,
 Jhaver Plaza, 1A, N.H. Road,
 Nungambakkam, Chennai - 34.
 Ph : 28263529 / 3530 / 3540
 Telefax : 28263527
 E-mail : enquiry@vectratech.in
 www.vectratech.in